

Crossover cable

We know some might have tried to connect two computers using your ethernet cable, that doesn't work as you need a Crossover cable to do this. The only difference here is that two pairs of wires are swapped positions to make a Crossover cable. If you are using two laptops then creating an Ad-hoc network would be more convenient.

Network Attached Storage

A network attached storage is simply a hard drive or array of hard drives connected to the network. NAS devices can simply be used as a communal storage device while maintaining the privacy and security of the individual members of the network. Then again NAS devices these days are much

CATEGORY	BANDWIDTH FREQUENCY	SPEED
Cat4	20 MHz	16 Mbit/s
Cat5	100 MHz	1000 Mbit/s
Cat5e	100 MHz	1000 Mbit/s
Cat6	250 MHz	10 Gbit/s
Cat6a	500 MHz	10 Gbit/s

more versatile with devices being brought out with custom OS on them and the ability to increment the features thanks to numerous official and community plugins.

A good NAS device can act as a storage medium, web server, media center and torrent box at the same time. If you have a good internet connection then you can host your personal website on a NAS device and do away with hosting charges altogether. They also have RAID functionality so your data is safe and secure and you have utmost control over it.

What to buy

When deciding on what hardware to invest there are a few pointers which we think you should consider.

1. Count the number of wired and wireless devices in the house / small business. Each router comes with a fixed number of ports (around 4 ports on mid-range routers) if you plan to connect more than 4 wired devices then invest in a switch.
2. Ensure as few breakages in cabling as possible, and no cable should be